NINE-BOX CUSTOMER DISCOVERY CANVAS

Use this worksheet to document evidence and questions. Do not fill unknowns with guesses.

CUSTOMER / PROJECT: Health Insurance Cashless authorization **FDE / TEAM: Shripathi Raman Radhakrishnan** **DATE / VERSION: 31-Oct-2026**

01 CUSTOMER & STAKEHOLDERS

Who owns the problem? Who uses the process? Who decides?

F - Several groups are involved in the cashless approval journey, including hospitals, insurance operations and customers.
F - Senior management has initiated the discovery effort due to growing concerns.
F - Multiple teams participate in processing and communicating authorization decisions.
U - Who owns the complete process from request submission to final decision?
U - Which teams have the biggest influence on processing time?
U - Who has final authority to approve process improvements?
D - Identify all stakeholders and map their responsibilities before analyzing solutions.

02 BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

Why change? What triggered the request? What matters?

F - Delayed authorizations are creating dissatisfaction among customers and hospitals.
F - Leadership wants evidence before committing to further investments.
F - The organization is concerned about long-term operational effectiveness.
U - Which business objective is the highest priority?
U - What target improvement is expected from this initiative?
U - How are delays currently measured by management?
D - Align with leadership on business priorities and success criteria.

03 EXPECTED OUTCOMES

What should improve? How will success be measured?

F - The organisation wants a clear understanding of what causes delays.
F - Faster and more predictable authorization decisions are desired.
F - Better visibility into request status would benefit stakeholders.
U - What turnaround time is considered acceptable?
U - Which KPIs will define project success?
U - What improvement level would be considered valuable?
D - Establish measurable outcomes before proposing improvements.

04 CURRENT PROCESS / AS-IS

What happens from request to closure? Where are handoffs?

F - Hospitals initiate requests on behalf of insured customers.
F - Requests are reviewed internally before a decision is issued.
F - Additional communication often occurs during request processing.
U - Where do requests spend most of their waiting time?
U - Which activities are manual and which are automated?
U - Are there unnecessary handoffs between teams?
D - Create a detailed process map of the current workflow.

05 CORE PROBLEM & PAIN POINTS

What is going wrong? What is verified?

F - Authorization requests are not being completed within expected timelines.
F - Hospital staff spend effort chasing status updates.
F - Internal teams spend considerable effort resolving pending cases.
U - What is the primary source of delay?
U - Are delays driven by people, process, data or technology?
U - Which stage contributes most to the backlog?
D - Validate root causes using operational evidence rather than assumptions.

06 BUSINESS IMPACT & BASELINE

How often? What cost, time, risk or rework results?

F - Customer experience is being affected by slower decisions.
F - Hospital relationships may be impacted by service delays.
F - Internal teams are spending time on follow-ups and rework.
U - What is the current average processing time?
U - How many requests miss expected timelines?
U - What is the financial impact of these delays?
D - Establish baseline metrics before measuring improvements.

07 DATA, SYSTEMS & CONSTRAINTS

What systems, data, rules and dependencies exist?

F - Digital platforms already support the authorization process.
F - More than one application participates in the workflow.
F - Operational decisions rely on information exchanged between systems.
U - Which systems are involved at each stage?
U - Are integration or data quality issues contributing to delays?
U - What regulatory constraints affect decision-making?
D - Review system architecture and data flow before recommending technology changes.

08 REQUIREMENTS & MVP OPTIONS

What capabilities might help? What is the smallest, useful pilot?

F - No preferred solution has been selected.
F - Stakeholders have differing views on the source of the problem.
F - Additional discovery is required before defining requirements.
U - Which capability would generate the fastest business value?
U - What improvement can be tested with minimal disruption?
U - Which existing tools can be leveraged first?
D - Delay solution selection until findings are validated.

09 VALIDATION & NEXT STEPS

What must be confirmed? Who owns each decision?

F - More evidence is needed to understand the delay pattern.
F - Operational teams possess important process knowledge.
F - Current assumptions have not been validated.
U - Which process step is the largest bottleneck?
U - How do hospitals and customers experience the delays?
U - Which assumptions are supported by data?
D - Conduct stakeholder interviews, collect metrics and validate findings before moving to implementation.